



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	12 April 2022	Time of Incident:	20:30 hrs
Region / Directorate:	Metropolitan Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	26668
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Two Trucks travelling wrong way in live lane.
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Executive Summary:

On 12th April 2022, at commencement of the night resurfacing works two heavy vehicle drivers – one contractor and the other from a sub-contractor – were travelling to the work site in the wrong lane from the prestart location (the carpark of nearby markets).

Both heavy vehicles had a combination of a truck (tractor unit) with a single float trailer. Sub-contractor had a 2m profiler on their float, Contractor had two rollers on their float – a total length of 19m and 17m respectively. Both heavy vehicles entered the market's carpark at approximately 21:35hrs off Bannister Road with no issues, and were able to park and attend the prestart which commenced at 22:00hrs.

When they proceeded to leave the carpark after prestart, they went to exit out on to Ranford Road which only had a left-hand turn, and a regulatory road sign prohibiting right hand turns. Due to ongoing roadworks in the area, there was temporary traffic management in place which restricted the heavy vehicles from turning left due to the congestion. There were temporary bollards in place down the centre of Ranford Road. Due to the length of the heavy vehicles, the bends in the road, and limited light reversing out of this area was not feasible.

The Sub-contractor driver who was in front turned on the vehicle hazard lights & beacons and watched the nearby traffic signals for a clear opening in the traffic; the Contractor driver did the same. When no vehicles were present both floats turned right onto Ranford Road and drove against the direction of travel for approximately 50m until they could move to the correct side of the road and into the worksite.

As they were approaching the traffic signals a Main Roads Traffic Worker was driving along Ranford Road and towards the floats. The MRWA vehicle dashcam captured footage of the two floats on the wrong side of the road as they approached the traffic signals.

The MRWA Traffic Worker reported the event immediately to the MRWA Surveillance Workers who were onsite to monitor the resurfacing works about to begin.

Incident Photos:

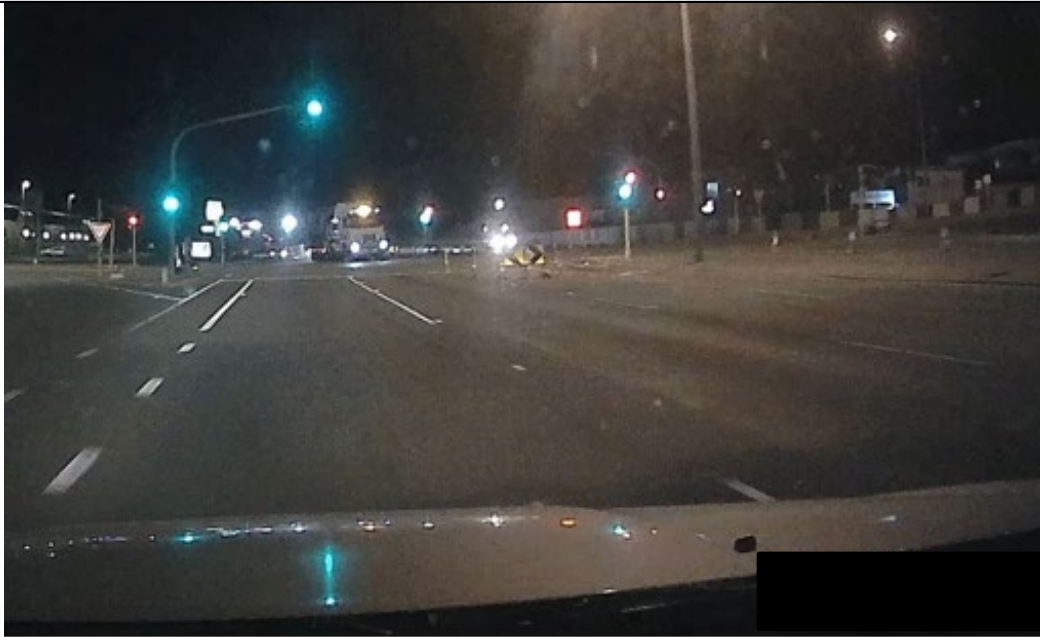


Image 1: Contractor heavy vehicle in the centre oncoming lane.



Image 2: Contractor heavy vehicle crossing over to the correct lane at the intersection



Image 3: Exit of the carpark on to Ranford Rd – Temporary Traffic Management in place with restricted space



Image 4: Exit of the carpark on to Ranford Rd – where heavy vehicles turned right

Contributing Factors:

- The drivers thought that what they were doing was safe.
- No entry and exit points were identified on the prestart location Vehicle Movement Plan (VMP).
- Drivers did not contact site supervisor or anyone to assist them to exit the area safely.
- Both drivers ignored a regulatory sign and travelled the wrong way on the road.
- The exit was too tight to turn for heavy vehicles.
- There is limited time to complete the resurfacing works which the drivers needed to unload the plant.
- No consideration was given to heavy vehicles in entering and exiting the prestart location.

Corrective Actions:

- Prestart locations that are going to have heavy vehicles attend must be scoped prior and confirmed as suitable on the prestart VMP.
- The prestart VMP is to identify the entry and exit points for heavy vehicles.
- Toolbox to reinforce the stop work authority and their requirements under legislation relating to duty of care.
- Refresher information to be provided to heavy vehicle drivers that includes chain of responsibility and road code requirements.
- Supervisors are to review the Contractor Incident Management Procedure, and ensure they understand the process when an incident occurs including the requirements for Alcohol & Other Drugs (AOD) testing.
- Communicate to the work crews including contractors that recording a 0.00 BAC must only occur when testing has (actually) occurred; Supervisors are to ensure compliance.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations